



also encountered some products that failed to leave any noticeable mark such as the Canon EOS M. In the end though, there's always only one winner for the Zerols, and here it is:

Zero1 winner

Olympus OM-D E-M1

The Olympus OM-D E-M1 is a DSLR-styled mirrorless camera that packs 16 megapixels onto a micro four thirds sensor, and while it's a smaller sensor than its Sony and Fujifilm counterparts, it's in no way a shy performer. The E-M1 has the fastest auto focus we've seen in a mirrorless camera. The image quality is absolutely stellar even at high ISOs and the number of lenses available for this system outnumber all others. The camera is incredibly versatile with a lot of configurable buttons that makes it easy to use for anyone. The best part about the camera is the twin-dial setup on the grip that allows settings to be changed not just quickly, but by using just one hand! This camera offers semi-professional DSLR performance with its fast AF, 10 frames per second burst mode speed and stellar image quality. While a few would consider it a little pricey, we think it's money well spent.

Worthy mentions

Fujifilm X-M1

Thus far, Fujifilm's X-series seemed targeted at a more exclusive buyer – going by the prices of the X-Pro and X-E1. However, with the launch of the X-M1, Fujifilm now offers a no-frills mirrorless camera for the masses. If you've loved the X-Trans sensor as much as we have, but couldn't afford it, well, now you can. Not only does it match the X-Pro1 and the X-E1 in terms of dynamic range and high ISO performance, it also packs in a Wi-Fi chip that the more expensive brethren don't have, and a tilt screen to make shooting with it even easier!

Panasonic GX7

The company that started it all! Panasonic has gone from having one mirrorless camera in its arsenal to having four distinct lineups in the same segment aimed at all kinds of users. The Panasonic Lumix GX7 is a camera that technically belongs to the enthusiast/semi-pro class, but this is a camera that breaks many boundaries. It may have a micro four thirds sensor, but it still delivers exceptional images, except in low light (one candle lit) scenes. The touch-based AF is just phenomenal and though not as fast as that of the OM-D E-M1, it has the ability to let you move the AF points around by just dragging your thumb across



Fujifilm X-M1

Price: ₹42,000



Panasonic GX7

Price: ₹57,000



Canon EOS 700D

Price: ₹51,000

the gorgeous 3-inch screen on the back. It also sports an electronic viewfinder that you can tilt upwards by 90-degrees so that you can frame your shots better.

The GX7's strongest suite however, is its boat-load of customisable buttons that come pre-mapped to the most commonly used features – even a complete amateur can pick this camera up and shoot with it without wasting time looking for hidden controls. Pros will love it too – it's versatile, compact (yet robust), and Panasonic (coupled with Olympus) offer a lens portfolio that is unmatched.

Entry-level DSLR

Digital Single Lens Reflex cameras have traditionally been the territory commanded by serious professionals, mostly due to the fact that in the earlier years, these cameras were crazy expensive and if you really wanted to get one, it would cost you a house, a car and maybe even a kidney or two. However, as is customary with technology, prices fall and target audiences expand.

To be honest, we've always had our reservations about this segment, since the cameras don't offer the right balance between price and performance for us, but even we're impressed with the 2013 launches.

Zero1 winner

Nikon D5200

The Nikon D5200 is a significant upgrade to the D5100. The EXPEED 3 chip that replaces the older one in the D5100 helps in fast function, but it's the AF system that impressed us. Of the 30 focus points, 9 are cross type, which help significantly when it comes to shooting moving subjects and even help in locking focus in low light. Speaking of low light, the 24 megapixel sensor can handle going all the way to ISO 6400 without generating any colour noise. Even when noise does start creeping into the shots, it looks more like fine grain rather than image destroying red-blue blotches. The D5200 is our best performer of 2013, despite not being the most expensive in the running. Impressive.

Worthy mention

Canon EOS 700D

Essentially the EOS 650D in a new body, the EOS 700D didn't really bring anything new to the dSLR table.